

# Dental Emergency Triage & Protocols

## Front Desk & Chairside Immediate Action Guidelines

| Emergency Condition                              | Urgency Level           | Immediate Clinic Action                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Avulsed Permanent Tooth (Knocked Out)            | CRITICAL (Under 60 Min) | Do not touch root. Store tooth in cold milk or saliva. Re-implant within 60 minutes for highest periodontal ligament survival.               |
| Facial Swelling / Trismus (Ludwig's Angina Risk) | CRITICAL (Immediate)    | Assess airway immediately. If floor of mouth elevated or breathing compromised, call 911 / EMS. Administer IV/oral antibiotics as indicated. |
| Severe Uncontrolled Post-Extraction Bleeding     | HIGH URGENCY            | Place firm pressure with bite gauge soaked in Tranexamic acid or tea bag for 30 minutes. Verify patient blood thinners (Warfarin/Aspirin).   |
| Acute Irreversible Pulpitis (Severe Pain)        | SAME-DAY URGENT         | Administer local anesthesia (2% Lidocaine/Articaine). Perform emergency pulpotomy / pulpectomy for immediate pain relief.                    |
| Fractured Tooth with Pulp Exposure               | SAME-DAY URGENT         | Assess pulpal bleeding. Direct pulp cap with MTA/Biodentine or pulpectomy. Cover with temporary glass ionomer restoration.                   |